

ADVANCED NETWORK SECURITY AND ARCHITECTURES

METI

Project Report [EN]

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1 Introduction

Group Encrypted Transport VPN (GETVPN) is a Cisco proprietary technology designed to provide scalable, any-to-any encrypted communication over private WAN infrastructures such as MPLS networks. Unlike traditional point-to-point IPsec VPNs, which require a dedicated tunnel between each pair of sites, GETVPN operates on a group key model: all participating routers share the same encryption keys and policy, allowing any member to securely communicate with any other member without the overhead of per-pair tunnel establishment.

The GETVPN architecture is built around two roles. The **Key Server (KS)** is responsible for generating and distributing cryptographic keys and security policies to all group participants. The **Group Members (GMs)** are the routers that register with the Key Server, receive the shared keys and traffic policies, and then encrypt or decrypt data traffic autonomously. Once registered, GMs communicate directly with each other; the Key Server is not involved in the data plane.

The goal of this project is to deploy and study a GETVPN solution in a simulated environment using GNS3, analyse the key management protocol exchanges, observe traffic encryption behaviour, and extend the base configuration with additional features. The remainder of this report describes the topology, the configuration steps, the observations made during the lab tasks, and the extensions implemented.

2 Topology and Base Configuration

The network topology used in this project is shown in Figure 1. It consists of four Cisco IOSv routers interconnected through a central switch. Router R1 acts as the Key Server and is connected to the shared segment 192.168.1.0/24 with address 192.168.1.254. Routers R2, R3, and R4 are the Group Members, with addresses 192.168.1.2, 192.168.1.3, and 192.168.1.4 respectively on their gi0/0 interfaces. Each Group Member also has a LAN-facing interface (gi0/1) connecting to a dedicated subnet: R2 serves 192.168.10.0/24, R3 serves 192.168.20.0/24, and R4 serves 192.168.30.0/24.

Three end hosts (PC1, PC2, PC3) are attached to these LAN subnets. Since the lab environment does not include dedicated PC images, Cisco 3725 routers were used to simulate the hosts; IP routing was disabled on these devices (`no ip routing`), and a default gateway static route was configured on each to point to the respective Group Member. Each simulated PC was assigned the .100 address of its subnet (e.g., PC1 at 192.168.10.100) and its icon was changed to a PC in GNS3 for clarity.

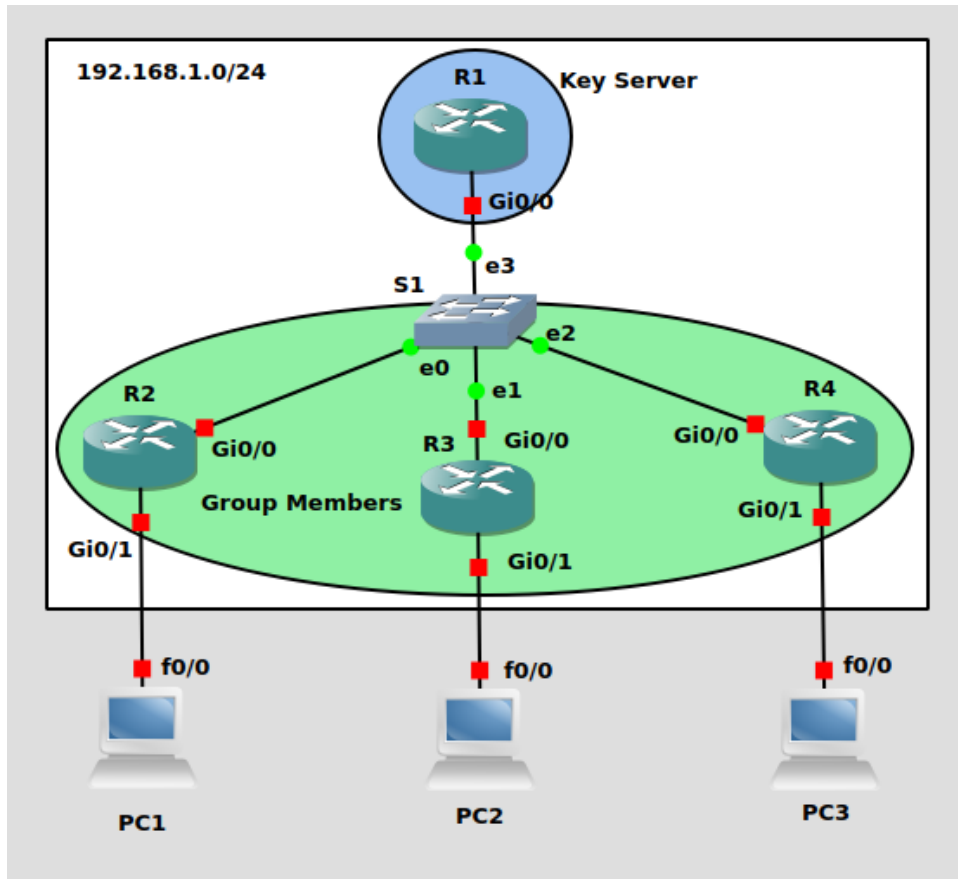


Figure 1: Project topology. R1 is the Key Server; R2, R3, and R4 are Group Members.

OSPF was chosen as the routing protocol and was configured on all four routers to advertise all connected networks. Prior to applying any GETVPN or IPsec configuration, end-to-end reachability was verified by pinging between all three PCs and between all router interfaces. All pings were successful, confirming that the routing layer was fully operational before any security configuration was introduced.

3 GETVPN Configuration

3.1 Overview of the Configuration Model

GETVPN security configuration is divided between the Key Server and the Group Members. The Key Server defines all security policy — the IKE parameters, the cryptographic algorithms, the traffic selector (which packets to encrypt), and the keys themselves — and distributes this policy to GMs during their registration. GMs only need to know how to authenticate with the KS and where to register; they receive everything else from the KS automatically.

The key management protocol used to distribute keys and policy is **GDOI (Group Domain of Interpretation)**, which runs over UDP port 848. The registration process has two phases: an IKE Phase 1 exchange that establishes a secure authenticated channel between the GM and the KS, followed by a **GROUPKEY-PULL** exchange in which the GM requests and receives the group keys and IPsec policy.

3.2 Key Server Configuration (R1)

3.2.1 IKE Phase 1 Policy

The first step is to define the parameters for the IKE Phase 1 exchange that will protect the GDOI registration channel between each GM and the KS. AES encryption, SHA hashing, pre-shared key authentication, and Diffie-Hellman group 5 are used. The wildcard address 0.0.0.0 allows the KS to accept registrations from any GM without listing each one individually.

```
! IKE Phase 1
R1(config)#crypto isakmp policy 10
R1(config-isakmp)#encryption aes
R1(config-isakmp)#hash sha
R1(config-isakmp)#authentication pre-share
R1(config-isakmp)#group 5
R1(config)#crypto isakmp key saar address 0.0.0.0
```

3.2.2 Transform Set and IPSec Profile

The *transform set* defines the cryptographic algorithms that will be applied to data traffic: ESP with AES for encryption and SHA-HMAC for integrity. The *IPSec profile* bundles the transform set into a named object that is later referenced inside the GDOI group configuration.

```
! Transform set (cipher suite for data traffic)
R1(config)#crypto ipsec transform-set myTSet esp-aes esp-sha-hmac

! IPSec profile (references the transform set)
R1(config)#crypto ipsec profile myIPSecProfile
R1(ipsec-profile)#set transform-set myTSet
```

3.2.3 RSA Key Pair

The KS signs its rekey messages using an RSA key pair so that GMs can verify the authenticity and integrity of key updates. The label `myRSAKeys` is used to reference this key pair in the GDOI group configuration.

```
R1(config)#crypto key generate rsa modulus 1024 label myRSAKeys
```

3.2.4 Traffic Selector ACL

GETVPN does not encrypt all traffic indiscriminately. An extended ACL defines the *interesting traffic* — the flows that should be protected. This ACL is configured on the KS and pushed to all GMs during registration. In this lab, only ICMP traffic is protected, which is sufficient for the ping-based verification tasks.

```
! Interesting traffic (what gets encrypted)
R1(config)#ip access-list extended ICMP
R1(config-ext-nacl)#permit icmp any any
```

3.2.5 GDOI Group

The GDOI group is the central object of the KS configuration. It ties together the identity number (which GMs must match to join the group), the KS address, the rekey mechanism, and the IPsec SA policy including the traffic selector.

```
R1(config)#crypto gdoi group myGDOIGroup
R1(config-gkm-group)#identity number 123
R1(config-gkm-group)#server local
R1(gkm-local-server)#address ipv4 192.168.1.254
R1(gkm-local-server)#rekey authentication mypubkey rsa myRSAKeys
R1(gkm-local-server)#rekey transport unicast
R1(gkm-local-server)#sa ipsec 10
R1(gkm-sa-ipsec)#profile myIPSecProfile
R1(gkm-sa-ipsec)#match address ipv4 ICMP
```

The `rekey transport unicast` directive instructs the KS to send key refresh messages directly to each registered GM individually, as opposed to multicast delivery.

3.3 Group Member Configuration (R2, R3, R4)

The configuration is identical on all three GMs; only the hostname differs. Each GM configures the same IKE Phase 1 parameters and pre-shared key as the KS, joins the GDOI group by its identity number and the KS address, and applies a crypto map to its WAN-facing interface to activate the received policy.

```
! IKE Phase 1 (must match KS policy)
Rx(config)#crypto isakmp policy 10
Rx(config-isakmp)#encryption aes
Rx(config-isakmp)#hash sha
Rx(config-isakmp)#authentication pre-share
Rx(config-isakmp)#group 5
Rx(config)#crypto isakmp key saar address 192.168.1.254

! Transform set (required locally, actual policy comes from KS)
Rx(config)#crypto ipsec transform-set TRANSFORM_SET esp-aes esp-sha-hmac

! GDOI group (must match KS identity number)
Rx(config)#crypto gdoi group myGDOIGroup
Rx(config-gkm-group)#identity number 123
Rx(config-gkm-group)#server address ipv4 192.168.1.254

! Crypto map applied to WAN interface
Rx(config)#crypto map myCryptoMap 10 gdoi
Rx(config-crypto-map)#set group myGDOIGroup
Rx(config)#interface gi0/0
Rx(config-if)#crypto map myCryptoMap
```

It is worth noting that the transform set defined locally on a GM is not used for data traffic; the actual IPSec policy (including transform set, traffic selector, and keys) is always received from the KS. The local transform set is only relevant for the IKE Phase 1 exchange during registration.

4 Verification

4.1 Key Server Status

After all GMs were configured, the `show crypto gdoi` and `show crypto gdoi ks members` commands were used on R1 to confirm correct operation.

```
R1#show crypto gdoi
GROUP INFORMATION

  Group Name           : myGDOIGroup (Unicast)
  Re-auth on new CRL   : Disabled
  Group Identity       : 123
  Group Type           : GDOI (ISAKMP)
  Crypto Path          : ipv4
  Key Management Path  : ipv4
  Group Members        : 3
  IPSec SA Direction   : Both
  IP D3P Window        : Disabled
  CKM status           : Disabled
  Group Rekey Lifetime : 86400 secs
  Group Rekey
    Remaining Lifetime : 86355 secs
    Time to Rekey      : 86130 secs
    Acknowledgement Cfg : Cisco
  Rekey Retransmit Period : 10 secs
  Rekey Retransmit Attempts: 2
  Group Retransmit
    Remaining Lifetime : 0 secs

  IPSec SA Number      : 10
  IPSec SA Rekey Lifetime: 3600 secs
  Profile Name         : myIPSecProfile
  Replay method        : Count Based
  Replay Window Size   : 64
  Tagging method       : Disabled
  SA Rekey
    Remaining Lifetime : 3556 secs
    Time to Rekey      : 3170 secs
  ACL Configured       : access-list ICMP

  Group Server list    : Local
```

Figure 2: show crypto gdoi on the Key Server (R1). Three Group Members registered.


```

R1#show crypto gdoi ks members

Group Member Information :

Number of rekeys sent for group myGDOIGroup : 0
Number of retransmits during the last rekey for group myGDOIGroup : 0
Duration of the last rekey for group myGDOIGroup : 0 msec

Group Member ID   : 192.168.1.2           GM Version: 1.0.17
Group ID          : 123
Group Name        : myGDOIGroup
Group Type        : GDOI (ISAKMP)
GM State          : Registered
Key Server ID     : 192.168.1.254
Rekeys sent       : 0
Rekeys retries    : 0
Rekey Acks Rcvd   : 0
Rekey Acks missed : 0

Sent seq num : 0      0      0      0
Rcvd seq num : 0      0      0      0

Group Member ID   : 192.168.1.3           GM Version: 1.0.17
Group ID          : 123

Group Member Information :

Group Name        : myGDOIGroup
Group Type        : GDOI (ISAKMP)
GM State          : Registered
Key Server ID     : 192.168.1.254
Rekeys sent       : 0
Rekeys retries    : 0
Rekey Acks Rcvd   : 0
Rekey Acks missed : 0

Sent seq num : 0      0      0      0
Rcvd seq num : 0      0      0      0

Group Member ID   : 192.168.1.4           GM Version: 1.0.17
Group ID          : 123
Group Name        : myGDOIGroup
Group Type        : GDOI (ISAKMP)
GM State          : Registered
Key Server ID     : 192.168.1.254
Rekeys sent       : 0
Rekeys retries    : 0
Rekey Acks Rcvd   : 0
Rekey Acks missed : 0

Group Member Information :

Sent seq num : 0      0      0      0
Rcvd seq num : 0      0      0      0

```

Figure 3: show crypto gdoi ks members on R1. All three GMs (192.168.1.2, .3, .4) show GM State: Registered.

The output confirms that all three GMs successfully completed the GROUPKEY-PULL exchange. Each entry shows GM State: Registered and identifies the correct Key Server address (192.168.1.254). The rekey counters are all zero, which is expected since no TEK refresh has occurred yet.

4.2 Group Member Status

The `show crypto gdoi` and `show crypto gdoi ipsec sa` commands were run on R2 as a representative Group Member.

Several important aspects of GETVPN operation are visible in the output from Figure 4:

- **Registration status:** R2 shows `Registration status: Registered`, confirming it successfully joined the group.
- **ACL received from KS:** The traffic selector (`permit icmp any any`) was pushed by the KS and installed on R2 as `gdoi_group.myGDOIGroup_temp_acl`. GMs do not define this locally.
- **TEK policy:** The Traffic Encryption Key policy shows `transform:esp-aes esp-sha-hmac` and SPI `0x6D2F03B9`, with a remaining lifetime of 3478 seconds. This is the key used to encrypt ICMP traffic between GMs.
- **KEK policy:** The Key Encryption Key uses 3DES with a lifetime of 86276 seconds and is used to protect future rekey messages from the KS. Notably, the KEK uses 3DES regardless of the AES algorithm specified in the IKE policy; this is a known behaviour in the IOS version used.
- **Active TEK Number: 1:** Confirms one TEK is active and ready to encrypt matching traffic.

```

R2#show crypto gdoi
GROUP INFORMATION

  Group Name           : myGDOIGroup
  Group Identity       : 123
  Group Type           : GDOI (ISAKMP)
  Crypto Path          : ipv4
  Key Management Path  : ipv4
  Rekeys received      : 0
  IPSec SA Direction   : Both

  Group Server list    : 192.168.1.254

Group Member Information For Group myGDOIGroup:
  IPSec SA Direction   : Both
  ACL Received From KS : gdoi_group_myGDOIGroup_temp_acl

  Group member         : 192.168.1.2      vrf: None
    Local addr/port    : 192.168.1.2/848
    Remote addr/port    : 192.168.1.254/848
    fvrf/ivrf          : None/None
    Version             : 1.0.17
    Registration status : Registered
    Registered with     : 192.168.1.254
    Re-registers in     : 3229 sec
    Succeeded registration: 1
    Attempted registration: 1
    Last rekey from     : 0.0.0.0
    Last rekey seq num  : 0
    Unicast rekey received: 0
    Rekey ACKs sent     : 0
    Rekey Received      : never
    DP Error Monitoring : OFF
    IPSEC init reg executed : 0
    IPSEC init reg postponed : 0
    Active TEK Number   : 1
    SA Track (OID/status) : disabled

  Rekeys cumulative
    Total received      : 0
    After latest register : 0
    Rekey Acks sents    : 0

  ACL Downloaded From KS 192.168.1.254:
  access-list permit icmp any any

KEK POLICY:
  Rekey Transport Type : Unicast
  Lifetime (secs)      : 86276
  Encrypt Algorithm     : 3DES
  Key Size              : 192
  Sig Hash Algorithm    : HMAC_AUTH_SHA
  Sig Key Length (bits) : 1296

TEK POLICY for the current KS-Policy ACES Downloaded:
GigabitEthernet0/0:
  IPsec SA:
    spi: 0x6D2F03B9(1831797689)
    KGS: Disabled
    transform: esp-aes esp-sha-hmac
    sa timing:remaining key lifetime (sec): (3478)
    Anti-Replay(Counter Based) : 64
    tag method : disabled
    alg key size: 16 (bytes)
    sig key size: 20 (bytes)
    encaps: ENCAPS_TUNNEL

```

Figure 4: show crypto gdoi on R2. Registration confirmed; TEK and KEK policies downloaded from KS.

5 Lab Tasks

5.1 IKE and GROUPKEY-PULL Analysis

To capture the GDOI registration exchanges, a Wireshark probe was placed on the link between the Key Server (R1) and the central switch before any Group Member was started. R1 was brought up first, followed by R2, R3, and R4 in sequence. The traffic on this link runs on UDP port 848, which Wireshark does not decode automatically. Figure 5 shows the raw capture before applying any decoder, with packets appearing as generic UDP. The *Decode As* feature was used to instruct Wireshark to interpret port 848 traffic as ISAKMP, after which the exchange types became readable.

No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Length	Info
82	11.368100	192.168.1.2	192.168.1.254	UDP	210	848 -> 848 Len=168
84	11.400215	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.2	UDP	150	848 -> 848 Len=108
85	11.579027	192.168.1.2	192.168.1.254	UDP	414	848 -> 848 Len=372
86	11.625902	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.2	UDP	410	848 -> 848 Len=368
87	11.684127	192.168.1.3	192.168.1.254	UDP	210	848 -> 848 Len=168
88	11.796866	192.168.1.2	192.168.1.254	UDP	150	848 -> 848 Len=108
89	11.835710	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.2	UDP	118	848 -> 848 Len=76
90	11.836983	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.3	UDP	150	848 -> 848 Len=108
91	11.890377	192.168.1.3	192.168.1.254	UDP	414	848 -> 848 Len=372
92	11.960476	192.168.1.4	192.168.1.254	UDP	210	848 -> 848 Len=168
93	12.002840	192.168.1.2	192.168.1.254	UDP	134	848 -> 848 Len=92
94	12.057683	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.3	UDP	410	848 -> 848 Len=368
95	12.059283	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.4	UDP	150	848 -> 848 Len=108
96	12.060734	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.2	UDP	278	848 -> 848 Len=236
97	12.104609	192.168.1.3	192.168.1.254	UDP	150	848 -> 848 Len=108
98	12.165482	192.168.1.4	192.168.1.254	UDP	414	848 -> 848 Len=372
99	12.206568	192.168.1.2	192.168.1.254	UDP	102	848 -> 848 Len=60
100	12.281874	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.3	UDP	118	848 -> 848 Len=76
101	12.283891	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.2	UDP	390	848 -> 848 Len=348
102	12.285297	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.4	UDP	410	848 -> 848 Len=368
103	12.310353	192.168.1.3	192.168.1.254	UDP	134	848 -> 848 Len=92
104	12.387496	192.168.1.4	192.168.1.254	UDP	150	848 -> 848 Len=108
105	12.493902	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.4	UDP	118	848 -> 848 Len=76
106	12.495173	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.3	UDP	278	848 -> 848 Len=236
107	12.519393	192.168.1.3	192.168.1.254	UDP	102	848 -> 848 Len=60
108	12.593413	192.168.1.4	192.168.1.254	UDP	134	848 -> 848 Len=92
109	12.702747	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.3	UDP	390	848 -> 848 Len=348
110	12.704298	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.4	UDP	278	848 -> 848 Len=236
111	12.796863	192.168.1.4	192.168.1.254	UDP	102	848 -> 848 Len=60
112	12.915493	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.4	UDP	390	848 -> 848 Len=348

Figure 5: Capture filtered on UDP port 848 before applying the ISAKMP decoder.

udp.port == 848						
No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Length	Info
42	40.060597	192.168.1.2	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	210	Identity Protection (Main Mode)
43	40.062094	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.2	ISAKMP	150	Identity Protection (Main Mode)
44	40.063573	192.168.1.2	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	414	Identity Protection (Main Mode)
45	40.068368	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.2	ISAKMP	410	Identity Protection (Main Mode)
46	40.073196	192.168.1.2	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	150	Identity Protection (Main Mode)
47	40.074337	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.2	ISAKMP	118	Identity Protection (Main Mode)
48	40.075796	192.168.1.2	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	134	Quick Mode
49	40.077498	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.2	ISAKMP	278	Quick Mode
50	40.078929	192.168.1.2	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	102	Quick Mode
51	40.080272	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.2	ISAKMP	390	Quick Mode
81	57.704422	192.168.1.3	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	210	Identity Protection (Main Mode)
82	57.705650	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.3	ISAKMP	150	Identity Protection (Main Mode)
83	57.707112	192.168.1.3	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	414	Identity Protection (Main Mode)
84	57.711980	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.3	ISAKMP	410	Identity Protection (Main Mode)
85	57.717009	192.168.1.3	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	150	Identity Protection (Main Mode)
86	57.718237	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.3	ISAKMP	118	Identity Protection (Main Mode)
87	57.719704	192.168.1.3	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	134	Quick Mode
88	57.721103	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.3	ISAKMP	278	Quick Mode
89	57.722382	192.168.1.3	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	102	Quick Mode
90	57.723661	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.3	ISAKMP	390	Quick Mode
123	73.357116	192.168.1.4	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	210	Identity Protection (Main Mode)
124	73.358365	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.4	ISAKMP	150	Identity Protection (Main Mode)
125	73.360259	192.168.1.4	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	414	Identity Protection (Main Mode)
126	73.365109	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.4	ISAKMP	410	Identity Protection (Main Mode)
127	73.370617	192.168.1.4	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	150	Identity Protection (Main Mode)
128	73.371927	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.4	ISAKMP	118	Identity Protection (Main Mode)
129	73.373833	192.168.1.4	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	134	Quick Mode
130	73.375309	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.4	ISAKMP	278	Quick Mode
131	73.376987	192.168.1.4	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	102	Quick Mode
132	73.378729	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.4	ISAKMP	390	Quick Mode

Figure 6: Capture filtered on UDP port 848 after applying the ISAKMP decoder.

5.1.1 IKE Phase 1 – Main Mode

For each Group Member, the capture shows six ISAKMP messages labelled *Identity Protection (Main Mode)* (exchange type 2), constituting the IKE Phase 1 exchange. These six messages serve a single purpose: to establish a mutually authenticated, encrypted channel between the GM and the KS before any key material is exchanged. The three pairs of messages carry out the following steps: the first pair negotiates the SA parameters (encryption algorithm, hash, authentication method, and DH group); the second pair performs the Diffie-Hellman key exchange, from which both sides derive a shared secret; and the third pair carries the encrypted authentication payloads, where each side proves its identity using the pre-shared key *saar*.

A detail visible in the first message of each registration (Figure 7) is that the *Responder SPI* field is 0x0000000000000000. This is expected: the KS has not yet responded, so no responder cookie has been assigned. By the end of Phase 1, both SPIs are populated, confirming the session is established. Also visible in this first message is the field *Domain of Interpretation: GDOI (2)*, which distinguishes this from a standard IPsec IKE negotiation (DOI 1) and confirms the session is being established specifically to support a GDOI group registration.

```

> Frame 42: 210 bytes on wire (1680 bits), 210 bytes captured (1680 bits) on interface -, id 0
> Ethernet II, Src: 0c:10:a8:28:00:00 (0c:10:a8:28:00:00), Dst: 0c:1b:5c:4a:00:00 (0c:1b:5c:4a:00:00)
> Internet Protocol Version 4, Src: 192.168.1.2, Dst: 192.168.1.254
> User Datagram Protocol, Src Port: 848, Dst Port: 848
- Internet Security Association and Key Management Protocol
  Initiator SPI: 9cab4fae013abe1c
  Responder SPI: 0000000000000000
  Next payload: Security Association (1)
- Version: 1.0
  0001 .... = MjVer: 0x1
  .... 0000 = MnVer: 0x0
  Exchange type: Identity Protection (Main Mode) (2)
- Flags: 0x00
  .... ..0 = Encryption: Not encrypted
  .... ..0 = Commit: No commit
  .... .0.. = Authentication: No authentication
  Message ID: 0x00000000
  Length: 168
- Payload: Security Association (1)
  Next payload: Vendor ID (13)
  Reserved: 00
  Payload length: 60
  Domain of interpretation: GDOI (2)
  Situation: 00000000
  SA Attribute Next Payload: 0000
  Reserved2: 0030
  > Payload: Vendor ID (13) : RFC 3947 Negotiation of NAT-Traversal in the IKE
  > Payload: Vendor ID (13) : draft-ietf-ipsec-nat-t-ike-07
  > Payload: Vendor ID (13) : draft-ietf-ipsec-nat-t-ike-03
  > Payload: Vendor ID (13) : draft-ietf-ipsec-nat-t-ike-02\n

```

Figure 7: First IKE Phase 1 message expanded. Note the null Responder SPI and Domain of Interpretation: GDOI (2).

5.1.2 GROUPKEY-PULL

Immediately following the six Phase 1 messages, four additional ISAKMP messages appear, labelled by Wireshark as *Quick Mode* (exchange type 32). These four messages constitute the **GROUPKEY-PULL** exchange, through which the GM requests and receives the group keys and IPsec policy from the KS. GDOI reuses the Quick Mode exchange type framing, which is why Wireshark labels them as such; the GDOI nature is confirmed by the DOI field observed in Phase 1.

Figures 8 and 8 show the four packets. All four share the same Message ID (0x64b4a54f), confirming they belong to the same exchange. The size of each packet is significant: the GM's initial request (packet 48) carries 64 bytes of encrypted data, while the KS responses carry 208 bytes (packet 49) and 320 bytes (packet 51). This asymmetry reflects the nature of the exchange — the GM sends a short registration request, while the KS response contains the full group policy: the Traffic Encryption Key (TEK), the Key Encryption Key (KEK), the traffic selector ACL, and the rekey parameters. All payloads are encrypted under the Phase 1 SA, so the key material itself is not visible in Wireshark. The fourth message (packet 50, 32 bytes) is the GM's acknowledgement completing the exchange.

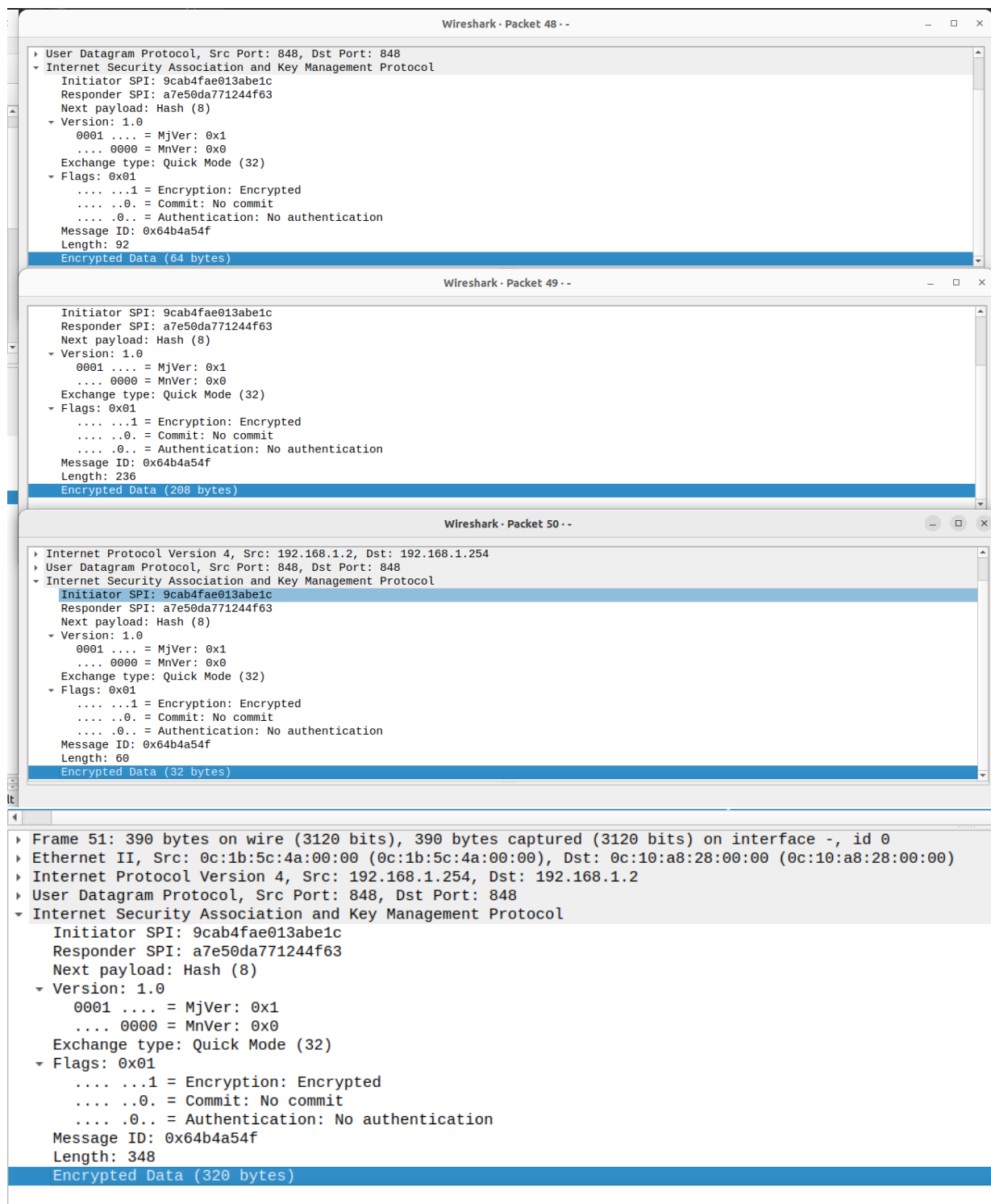


Figure 8: GROUPKEY-PULL exchange (Quick Mode, exchange type 32) between R2 and the Key Server.

5.1.3 Repeated Pattern Across All Group Members

The identical 10-message pattern (6 Main Mode + 4 Quick Mode) was observed independently for each of the three Group Members, as shown in Figures 9, 10, and 11. Each GM performs its own IKE Phase 1 and GROUPKEY-PULL with the KS independently. The KS distributes the same TEK and policy to all three, which is what allows any GM to decrypt traffic encrypted by any other GM.

40 38.588684	192.168.1.254	224.0.0.5	OSPF	94 Hello Packet
41 38.589334	192.168.1.2	192.168.1.254	OSPF	94 Hello Packet
42 40.060597	192.168.1.2	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	210 Identity Protection (Main Mode)
43 40.062094	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.2	ISAKMP	150 Identity Protection (Main Mode)
44 40.063573	192.168.1.2	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	414 Identity Protection (Main Mode)
45 40.068368	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.2	ISAKMP	410 Identity Protection (Main Mode)
46 40.073196	192.168.1.2	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	150 Identity Protection (Main Mode)
47 40.074337	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.2	ISAKMP	118 Identity Protection (Main Mode)
48 40.075796	192.168.1.2	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	134 Quick Mode
49 40.077498	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.2	ISAKMP	278 Quick Mode
50 40.078929	192.168.1.2	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	102 Quick Mode
51 40.080272	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.2	ISAKMP	390 Quick Mode
52 40.105590	192.168.1.2	224.0.0.5	OSPF	94 Hello Packet
53 40.963312	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.2	OSPF	78 DB Description
54 45.784618	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.2	OSPF	78 DB Description
55 47.881050	0c:01:5c:a4:00:00	Broadcast	ARP	60 Gratuitous ARP for 192.168.1.2 (Reply)

Figure 9: 10-message registration sequence for R2 (packets 42–51).

79 56.825291	192.168.1.3	192.168.1.254	OSPF	98 Hello Packet
80 56.825722	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.3	OSPF	78 DB Description
81 57.704422	192.168.1.3	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	210 Identity Protection (Main Mode)
82 57.705650	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.3	ISAKMP	150 Identity Protection (Main Mode)
83 57.707112	192.168.1.3	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	414 Identity Protection (Main Mode)
84 57.711980	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.3	ISAKMP	410 Identity Protection (Main Mode)
85 57.717009	192.168.1.3	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	150 Identity Protection (Main Mode)
86 57.718237	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.3	ISAKMP	118 Identity Protection (Main Mode)
87 57.719704	192.168.1.3	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	134 Quick Mode
88 57.721103	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.3	ISAKMP	278 Quick Mode
89 57.722382	192.168.1.3	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	102 Quick Mode
90 57.723661	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.3	ISAKMP	390 Quick Mode
91 57.828611	0c:1b:5c:4a:00:00	0c:1b:5c:4a:00:00	LOOP	60 Reply
92 57.892466	192.168.1.3	224.0.0.5	OSPF	98 Hello Packet
93 59.216737	192.168.1.2	224.0.0.5	OSPF	98 Hello Packet
94 61.708108	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.3	OSPF	78 DB Description
95 63.072595	0c:65:00:07:00:00	Broadcast	ARP	60 Gratuitous ARP for 192.168.1.4 (Reply)

Figure 10: 10-message registration sequence for R3.

120 70.072597	0c:65:00:07:00:00	CDP/VTP/DTP/PagP/UD... CDP	CDP	356 Device ID: R4 Port ID: GigabitEth
121 71.469595	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.4	OSPF	78 DB Description
122 71.672462	0c:65:00:07:00:00	CDP/VTP/DTP/PagP/UD... CDP	CDP	356 Device ID: R4 Port ID: GigabitEth
123 73.357116	192.168.1.4	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	210 Identity Protection (Main Mode)
124 73.358365	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.4	ISAKMP	150 Identity Protection (Main Mode)
125 73.360259	192.168.1.4	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	414 Identity Protection (Main Mode)
126 73.365109	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.4	ISAKMP	410 Identity Protection (Main Mode)
127 73.370617	192.168.1.4	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	150 Identity Protection (Main Mode)
128 73.371927	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.4	ISAKMP	118 Identity Protection (Main Mode)
129 73.373833	192.168.1.4	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	134 Quick Mode
130 73.375309	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.4	ISAKMP	278 Quick Mode
131 73.376987	192.168.1.4	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	102 Quick Mode
132 73.378729	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.4	ISAKMP	390 Quick Mode
133 74.073061	192.168.1.4	224.0.0.5	OSPF	102 Hello Packet
134 75.710951	192.168.1.254	224.0.0.5	OSPF	102 Hello Packet
135 76.073921	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.4	OSPF	78 DB Description
136 76.606690	192.168.1.3	224.0.0.5	OSPF	102 Hello Packet
137 77.825655	0c:1b:5c:4a:00:00	0c:1b:5c:4a:00:00	LOOP	60 Reply

Figure 11: 10-message registration sequence for R4.

5.2 SPI Consistency Across Group Members

A fundamental property of GETVPN is that all Group Members share a single Traffic Encryption Key (TEK), meaning all encrypted traffic within the group carries the same Security

Parameter Index (SPI) regardless of source or destination. This was verified by capturing ESP traffic at the link between R2 and the switch while pinging from PC1 to both PC2 and PC3.

5.2.1 Wireshark Capture

Figures 12 and 13 show the ESP packets captured during the two ping sessions. In both cases — PC1 to PC2 (192.168.10.100 → 192.168.20.100) and PC1 to PC3 (192.168.10.100 → 192.168.30.100) — every ESP packet carries SPI=0x24FF23B1. Despite the traffic being destined for different Group Members, the SPI is identical in both captures. Expanding any individual packet confirms ESP SPI: 0x24ff23b1 (620700593).

170 66.193612	00:10:a8:20:00:00	00:10:a8:20:00:00	LOOP	60 Reply
179 66.979768	192.168.1.2	224.0.0.5	OSPF	102 Hello Packet
180 67.220152	192.168.10.100	192.168.20.100	ESP	182 ESP (SPI=0x24ff23b1)
181 67.225917	192.168.20.100	192.168.10.100	ESP	182 ESP (SPI=0x24ff23b1)
182 67.230260	192.168.10.100	192.168.20.100	ESP	182 ESP (SPI=0x24ff23b1)
183 67.236024	192.168.20.100	192.168.10.100	ESP	182 ESP (SPI=0x24ff23b1)
184 67.240297	192.168.10.100	192.168.20.100	ESP	182 ESP (SPI=0x24ff23b1)
185 67.246429	192.168.20.100	192.168.10.100	ESP	182 ESP (SPI=0x24ff23b1)
186 67.250354	192.168.10.100	192.168.20.100	ESP	182 ESP (SPI=0x24ff23b1)
187 67.256272	192.168.20.100	192.168.10.100	ESP	182 ESP (SPI=0x24ff23b1)
188 67.260515	192.168.10.100	192.168.20.100	ESP	182 ESP (SPI=0x24ff23b1)
189 67.266339	192.168.20.100	192.168.10.100	ESP	182 ESP (SPI=0x24ff23b1)
190 68.180326	192.168.1.4	224.0.0.5	OSPF	102 Hello Packet
191 68.950699	192.168.1.3	224.0.0.5	OSPF	102 Hello Packet
▶ Frame 180: 182 bytes on wire (1456 bits), 182 bytes captured (1456 bits) on interface -, id 0 ▶ Ethernet II, Src: 0c:10:a8:28:00:00 (0c:10:a8:28:00:00), Dst: 0c:01:b9:7f:00:00 (0c:01:b9:7f:00:00) ▶ Internet Protocol Version 4, Src: 192.168.10.100, Dst: 192.168.20.100 ▼ Encapsulating Security Payload ESP SPI: 0x24ff23b1 (620700593) ESP Sequence: 5 ▼ [Expected SN: 3 (2 SNs missing)] ▼ [Expert Info (Warning/Sequence): Wrong Sequence Number for SPI 24ff23b1 - 2 missing] [Wrong Sequence Number for SPI 24ff23b1 - 2 missing] [Severity level: Warning] [Group: Sequence] [Previous Frame: 171]				

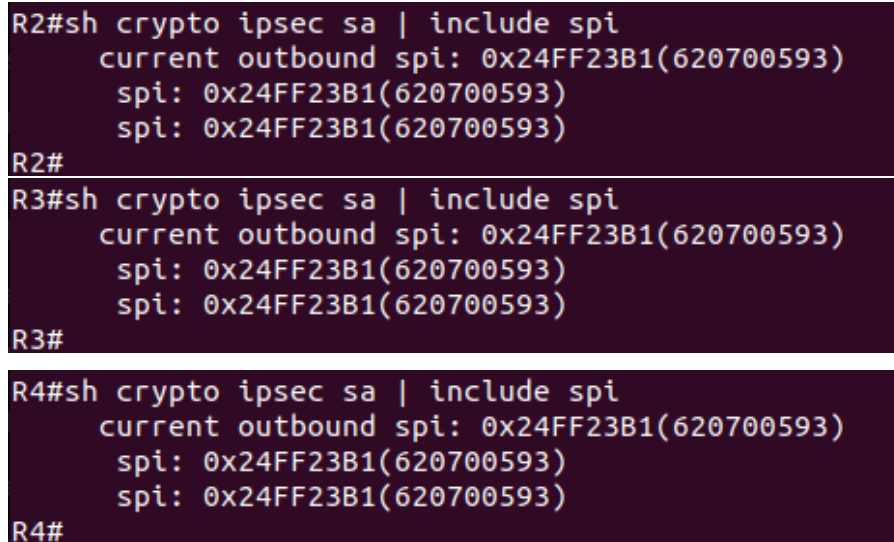
Figure 12: ESP packets captured for PC1 → PC2 ping. All packets carry SPI=0x24FF23B1.

191 70.039202	192.168.1.3	224.0.0.5	OSPF	102 Hello Packet
198 79.190168	192.168.10.100	192.168.30.100	ESP	182 ESP (SPI=0x24ff23b1)
199 80.196124	192.168.10.100	192.168.30.100	ESP	182 ESP (SPI=0x24ff23b1)
200 80.201638	192.168.30.100	192.168.10.100	ESP	182 ESP (SPI=0x24ff23b1)
201 80.206133	192.168.10.100	192.168.30.100	ESP	182 ESP (SPI=0x24ff23b1)
202 80.211683	192.168.30.100	192.168.10.100	ESP	182 ESP (SPI=0x24ff23b1)
203 80.216145	192.168.10.100	192.168.30.100	ESP	182 ESP (SPI=0x24ff23b1)
204 80.221669	192.168.30.100	192.168.10.100	ESP	182 ESP (SPI=0x24ff23b1)
205 80.226220	192.168.10.100	192.168.30.100	ESP	182 ESP (SPI=0x24ff23b1)
206 80.232068	192.168.30.100	192.168.10.100	ESP	182 ESP (SPI=0x24ff23b1)
207 86.050837	192.168.1.2	224.0.0.5	OSPF	102 Hello Packet
208 86.200801	0c:10:a8:28:00:00	0c:10:a8:28:00:00	LOOP	60 Reply
209 86.734682	192.168.1.4	224.0.0.5	OSPF	102 Hello Packet
210 87.879501	192.168.1.254	224.0.0.5	OSPF	102 Hello Packet
▶ Frame 198: 182 bytes on wire (1456 bits), 182 bytes captured (1456 bits) on interface -, id 0 ▶ Ethernet II, Src: 0c:10:a8:28:00:00 (0c:10:a8:28:00:00), Dst: 0c:65:00:07:00:00 (0c:65:00:07:00:00) ▶ Internet Protocol Version 4, Src: 192.168.10.100, Dst: 192.168.30.100 ▼ Encapsulating Security Payload ESP SPI: 0x24ff23b1 (620700593) ESP Sequence: 10 ▼ [Expected SN: 8 (2 SNs missing)] ▼ [Expert Info (Warning/Sequence): Wrong Sequence Number for SPI 24ff23b1 - 2 missing] [Wrong Sequence Number for SPI 24ff23b1 - 2 missing] [Severity level: Warning] [Group: Sequence] [Previous Frame: 189]				

Figure 13: ESP packets captured for PC1 → PC3 ping. Same SPI value despite different destination.

5.2.2 CLI Verification

The `show crypto ipsec sa | include spi` command was run on all three Group Members to confirm the shared SPI at the router level:



```
R2#sh crypto ipsec sa | include spi
    current outbound spi: 0x24FF23B1(620700593)
    spi: 0x24FF23B1(620700593)
    spi: 0x24FF23B1(620700593)
R2#
R3#sh crypto ipsec sa | include spi
    current outbound spi: 0x24FF23B1(620700593)
    spi: 0x24FF23B1(620700593)
    spi: 0x24FF23B1(620700593)
R3#
R4#sh crypto ipsec sa | include spi
    current outbound spi: 0x24FF23B1(620700593)
    spi: 0x24FF23B1(620700593)
    spi: 0x24FF23B1(620700593)
R4#
```

Figure 14: `show crypto ipsec sa | include spi` across all Group Members showing that they all have the same SPI

All three GMs report the same SPI value, confirming they hold an identical TEK. The TEK policy at the Key Server, visible in the `show crypto gdoi ks policy` output (Figure 15), confirms that `spi: 0x24FF23B1` is the single TEK distributed to the group, with `transform: esp-aes esp-sha-hmac` and an original lifetime of 3600 seconds.

```

R1#show crypto gdoi ks policy
Key Server Policy:
For group myGDOIGroup (handle: 2147483650) server 192.168.1.254 (handle: 2147483650):

# of teks : 1 Seq num : 0
KEK POLICY (transport type : Unicast)
spi : 0xF3610BE03FC8CD96B1E069A3815260A3
management alg      : disabled      encrypt alg         : 3DES
crypto iv length    : 8              key size           : 24
orig life(sec)      : 86400          remaining life(sec): 86048
time to rekey (sec) : 85823
sig hash algorithm  : enabled        sig key length      : 162
sig size            : 128
sig key name        : myRSAKeys
acknowledgement     : Cisco

TEK POLICY (encaps : ENCAPS_TUNNEL)
spi                : 0x24FF23B1
access-list        : ICMP
CKM rekey epoch    : N/A (disabled)
transform          : esp-aes esp-sha-hmac
alg key size       : 16              sig key size        : 20
orig life(sec)     : 3600            remaining life(sec)  : 3249
tek life(sec)      : 3600            elapsed time(sec)    : 351
override life (sec): 0               antireplay window size: 64
time to rekey (sec): 2863
R1#

```

Figure 15: show crypto gdoi ks policy on R1 confirming the TEK SPI and policy distributed to all GMs.

5.2.3 Why All SPIs Are Identical

In a traditional point-to-point IPsec VPN, each pair of endpoints negotiates its own independent SA with a unique SPI. In GETVPN, the Key Server generates a single TEK and distributes it to all Group Members simultaneously during the GROUPKEY-PULL exchange. Because every GM holds the same key, any GM can decrypt traffic encrypted by any other GM without prior negotiation. The shared SPI is the identifier for this common key, which is why it appears identically on R2, R3, and R4 and in every ESP packet on the wire, regardless of which pair of hosts is communicating.

It is worth noting that the SPI observed here (0x24FF23B1) differs from the one seen during the initial verification (0x6D2F03B9). This is because the TEK has a lifetime of 3600 seconds and was refreshed between the two observations. The rekey process — in which the KS distributes a new TEK to all GMs before the old one expires — is examined in the following task.

5.3 TEK Rekey Observation

To observe the TEK refresh process, the IPsec SA lifetime on the Key Server was reduced to 900 seconds by adding the following command to the IPsec profile:

```

R1(config)#crypto ipsec profile myIPsecProfile
R1(ipsec-profile)#set security-association lifetime seconds 900

```

Rather than waiting for the timer to expire naturally, the rekey was triggered immediately using the command `crypto gdoi ks rekey` like shown in the Figure 16.

```
R1#crypto gdoi ks rekey
R1#
*Jun  3 15:53:14.253: %GDOI-5-KS_SEND_UNICAST_REKEY: Sending Unicast Rekey with policy-replace for group myGDOIGroup from address 192.168.1.254 with se
q # 1 spi: 0xF3610BE03FC8CD96B1E069A3815260A3
```

Figure 16: Output of the command `crypto gdoi ks rekey` in R1

Figure 17 confirms that the 900 second lifetime was active at the time, with the SA showing a remaining lifetime of 893 seconds and a time to rekey of 777 seconds — well within the configured bound and counting down as expected.

```

tagging method      : Disabled
SA Rekey
  Remaining Lifetime : 893 secs
  Time to Rekey      : 777 secs
ACL Configured      : access-list ICMP

Group Server list   : Local
R1#
```

Figure 17: `show crypto gdoi` on R1 showing the 900 second TEK lifetime in effect after to the manual rekey.

5.3.1 Rekey Messages in Wireshark

Figure 18 shows the Wireshark capture taken at the R1-switch link at the moment the rekey was triggered. Six ISAKMP messages appear in quick succession: three rekey messages from the KS to each GM (packets 47, 49, 51) and three acknowledgements from the GMs back to the KS (packets 48, 50, 52).

44	72.629189	192.168.1.3	224.0.0.5	OSPF	102 Hello Packet
45	73.088537	192.168.1.4	224.0.0.5	OSPF	102 Hello Packet
46	75.690525	192.168.1.2	224.0.0.5	OSPF	102 Hello Packet
47	76.855014	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.2	ISAKMP	774 New Group Mode
48	76.861044	192.168.1.2	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	118 Unknown 34
49	76.863582	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.3	ISAKMP	774 New Group Mode
50	76.869831	192.168.1.3	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	118 Unknown 34
51	76.871223	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.4	ISAKMP	774 New Group Mode
52	76.875951	192.168.1.4	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	118 Unknown 34
53	79.234462	192.168.1.254	224.0.0.5	OSPF	102 Hello Packet
54	80.270658	0c:10:a8:28:00:00	CDP/VTP/DTP/PAGP/UD...	CDP	356 Device ID: R2 Port ID:
55	81.031266	0c:1b:5c:4a:00:00	0c:1b:5c:4a:00:00	LOOP	60 Reply
56	82.157552	192.168.1.3	224.0.0.5	OSPF	102 Hello Packet
57	82.623183	192.168.1.4	224.0.0.5	OSPF	102 Hello Packet
▶ Frame 51: 774 bytes on wire (6192 bits), 774 bytes captured (6192 bits) on interface -, id 0 ▶ Ethernet II, Src: 0c:1b:5c:4a:00:00 (0c:1b:5c:4a:00:00), Dst: 0c:65:00:07:00:00 (0c:65:00:07:00:00) ▶ Internet Protocol Version 4, Src: 192.168.1.254, Dst: 192.168.1.4 ▶ User Datagram Protocol, Src Port: 848, Dst Port: 848 ▶ Internet Security Association and Key Management Protocol Initiator SPI: f3610be03fc8cd96 Responder SPI: b1e069a3815260a3 Next payload: Sequence Number (18) ◀ Version: 1.0 0001 = MjVer: 0x1 0000 = MnVer: 0x0 Exchange type: New Group Mode (33) ▶ Flags: 0x01 Message ID: 0x00000000 Length: 732 Encrypted Data (704 bytes)					

Figure 18: Wireshark capture of the rekey event. Three unicast rekey messages from R1 (192.168.1.254) to each GM, followed by acknowledgements.

5.3.2 Exchange Type

Expanding packet 51 (Figure 18) reveals **Exchange type: New Group Mode (33)**. This differs from both the IKE Phase 1 exchange (Main Mode, type 2) and the initial GROUPKEY-PULL (Quick Mode, type 32). New Group Mode (type 33) is the GDOI-specific exchange used exclusively for pushing refreshed key material from a KS to already-registered GMs. The acknowledgement messages use exchange type 34. The direction of the exchange is also reversed compared to GROUPKEY-PULL: here the KS initiates by pushing the new TEK to GMs, rather than GMs pulling from the KS.

All three rekey messages share **Message ID: 0x00000000**, which is the fixed message ID used for GDOI rekey messages. Each packet carries 704 bytes of encrypted data — larger than the original GROUPKEY-PULL responses — as the payload includes the new TEK, updated policy parameters, and the RSA signature used by GMs to verify the authenticity of the rekey message. Since **rekey transport unicast** was configured, the KS sends one independent message to each GM rather than a single multicast.

5.3.3 What Changed

After the rekey completed, the SPI on all GMs changed to a new value, confirming that a new TEK was successfully installed:

```

*Jun  3 16:06:20.195: NGDOI-S-SA_TEK_UPDATED: SA TEK was updated
*Jun  3 16:06:20.197: NGDOI-S-CM_RECV_REKEY: Received Rekey for group myGDOIGroup from 192.168.1.254 to 192.168.1.2 with seq # 1, spi 0x308BA98295CA1CD
#5C0D3F209D5B796A
*Jun  3 16:06:20.199: NGDOI-S-CM_INSTALL_POLICIES_SUCCESS: SUCCESS: Installation of Reg/Rekey policies from KS 192.168.1.254 for group myGDOIGroup & gn
Identity 192.168.1.2 Ivrf default Ivrf default
R2#sh crypto ipsec sa | include spi
current outbound spi: 0xA3806B39(2743102265)
spi: 0x580F7BAA(1477489700)
spi: 0xA3806B39(2743102265)
spi: 0x580F7BAA(1477489700)
spi: 0xA3806B39(2743102265)
R2#
*Jun  3 16:06:20.475: NGDOI-S-SA_TEK_UPDATED: SA TEK was updated
*Jun  3 16:06:20.477: NGDOI-S-CM_RECV_REKEY: Received Rekey for group myGDOIGroup from 192.168.1.254 to 192.168.1.3 with seq # 1, spi 0x308BA98295CA1CD
#5C0D3F209D5B796A
*Jun  3 16:06:20.480: NGDOI-S-CM_INSTALL_POLICIES_SUCCESS: SUCCESS: Installation of Reg/Rekey policies from KS 192.168.1.254 for group myGDOIGroup & gn
Identity 192.168.1.3 Ivrf default Ivrf default
R3#sh crypto ipsec sa | include spi
current outbound spi: 0x580F7BAA(1477489700)
spi: 0x580F7BAA(1477489700)
spi: 0xA3806B39(2743102265)
spi: 0x580F7BAA(1477489700)
spi: 0xA3806B39(2743102265)
R3#
*Jun  3 16:06:20.516: NGDOI-S-SA_TEK_UPDATED: SA TEK was updated
*Jun  3 16:06:20.518: NGDOI-S-CM_RECV_REKEY: Received Rekey for group myGDOIGroup from 192.168.1.254 to 192.168.1.4 with seq # 1, spi 0x308BA98295CA1CD
#5C0D3F209D5B796A
*Jun  3 16:06:20.520: NGDOI-S-CM_INSTALL_POLICIES_SUCCESS: SUCCESS: Installation of Reg/Rekey policies from KS 192.168.1.254 for group myGDOIGroup & gn
Identity 192.168.1.4 Ivrf default Ivrf default
R4#sh crypto ipsec sa | include spi
current outbound spi: 0x580F7BAA(1477489700)
spi: 0x580F7BAA(1477489700)
spi: 0xA3806B39(2743102265)
spi: 0x580F7BAA(1477489700)
spi: 0xA3806B39(2743102265)
R4#

```

Figure 19: show crypto ipsec sa | include spi across all Group Members after the rekeying

The Key Encryption Key (KEK) was not replaced during this event — only the TEK changed. The KEK has a much longer lifetime (86400 seconds) and is used to protect the rekey messages themselves; it is only refreshed on a separate, less frequent schedule. This separation of TEK and KEK lifetimes is a deliberate design choice in GETVPN: TEKs rotate frequently to limit the exposure of any single key, while the KEK rotates less often to reduce management overhead.

6 GETVPN Extensions

6.1 COOP Redundancy

6.1.1 Overview

In the base GETVPN configuration, R1 is the sole Key Server. If R1 becomes unavailable, Group Members can no longer rekey and will eventually lose the ability to encrypt traffic once the current TEK expires. To address this single point of failure, Cisco’s **Cooperative Key Server (COOP)** mechanism allows multiple Key Servers to operate together, providing redundancy. The KSs elect a **Primary** and a **Secondary** based on configured priority values. The Primary handles all GM registrations and rekeys under normal operation, while the Secondary maintains synchronised group state via a secure channel between the two KSs. If the Primary becomes unreachable, the Secondary detects the failure through missed heartbeat announcements and promotes itself to Primary, after which GMs re-register with it.

For this extension, a fifth router R5 was added to the topology at address 192.168.1.252, connected to the same shared segment as the other routers and participating in OSPF. Figure 20 shows the updated topology.

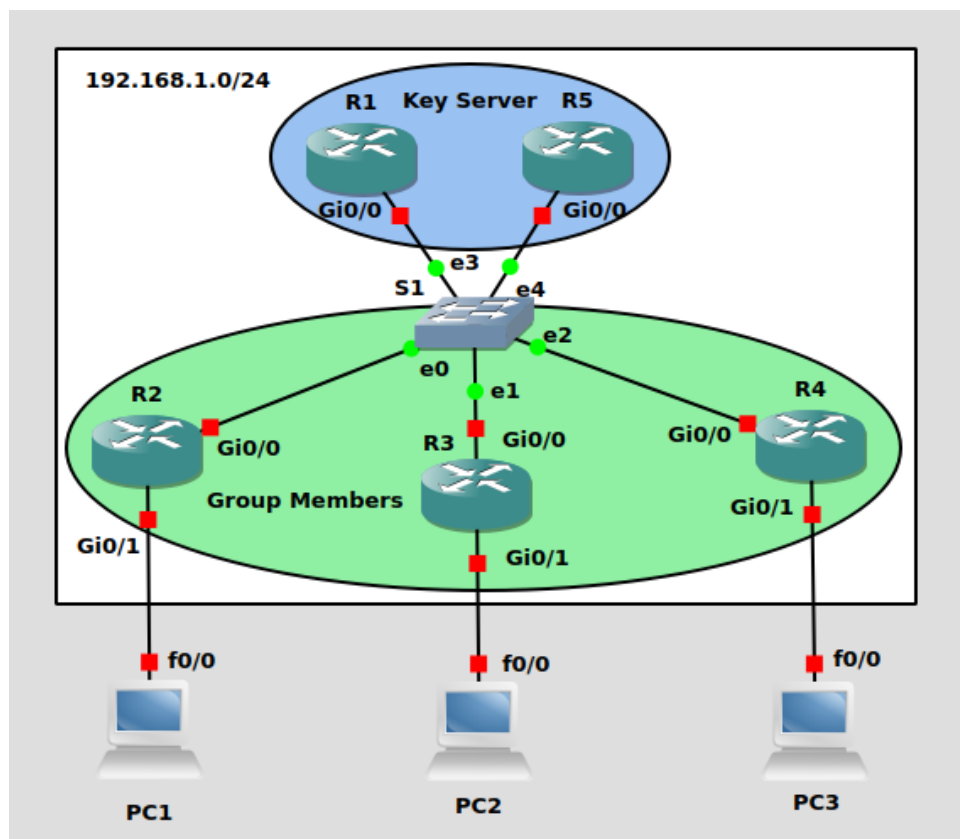


Figure 20: Updated topology with R5 added as the Secondary Key Server.

6.1.2 COOP Configuration

R5 was configured with the same base GETVPN security policy as R1 — identical IKE Phase 1 parameters, transform set, IPSec profile, RSA key pair, traffic ACL, and GDOI group. The COOP-specific addition is the **redundancy** block inside the **server** local configuration, which declares the peer KS address and the local priority:

```
! On R1 - add COOP peer and set priority
R1(config)#crypto gdoi group myGDOIGroup
R1(config-gkm-group)#server local
R1(gkm-local-server)#redundancy
R1(gkm-ks-redundancy)#local priority 100
R1(gkm-ks-redundancy)#peer address ipv4 192.168.1.252

! On R5 - same structure, lower priority
R5(config)#crypto gdoi group myGDOIGroup
R5(config-gkm-group)#server local
R5(gkm-local-server)#redundancy
R5(gkm-ks-redundancy)#local priority 75
R5(gkm-ks-redundancy)#peer address ipv4 192.168.1.254
```

R1 was assigned priority 100 and R5 priority 75, making R1 the Primary. Each GM was

updated to include R5 as a secondary KS address:

```
Rx(config)#crypto gdoi group myGDOIGroup
Rx(config-gkm-group)#server address ipv4 192.168.1.252
```

6.1.3 Steady-State Verification

Figures 21 and 22 show the COOP status on both KSs under normal operation. R1 reports Local KS Role: Primary and R5 reports Local KS Role: Secondary, with both peers showing KS Status: Alive and IKE status: Established. The Primary sends periodic announcement messages to the Secondary every 20 seconds (Primary Refresh Policy Time: 20); the Secondary expects these every 30 seconds (Sec Primary Periodic Time: 30) and will initiate a role transition if they stop arriving.

```
R1#show crypto gdoi ks coop
Crypto Gdoi Group Name :myGDOIGroup
  Group handle: 2147483650, Local Key Server handle: 2147483650

  Local Address: 192.168.1.254
  Local Priority: 100
  Local KS Role: Primary , Local KS Status: Alive
  Local KS version: 1.0.18
  Primary Timers:
    Primary Refresh Policy Time: 20
    Remaining Time: 14
    Per-user timer remaining time: 0
    Antireplay Sequence Number: 7
  Peer Sessions:
  Session 1:
    Server handle: 2147483651
    Peer Address: 192.168.1.252
    Peer Version: 1.0.18
    Peer Priority: 75
    Peer KS Role: Secondary , Peer KS Status: Alive
    Antireplay Sequence Number: 4

  IKE status: Established
  Counters:
    Ann msgs sent: 6
    Ann msgs sent with reply request: 1
    Ann msgs rcv: 2
    Ann msgs rcv with reply request: 0
    Packet sent drops: 0
    Packet Recv drops: 0
    Total bytes sent: 4373
    Total bytes rcv: 1238

R1#
```

Figure 21: show crypto gdoi ks coop on R1. Primary role confirmed, R5 visible as Secondary peer.


```

R5#show crypto gdoi ks coop
Crypto Gdoi Group Name :myGDOIGroup
  Group handle: 2147483650, Local Key Server handle: 2147483650

  Local Address: 192.168.1.252
  Local Priority: 75
  Local KS Role: Secondary , Local KS Status: Alive
  Local KS version: 1.0.18
  Secondary Timers:
    Sec Primary Periodic Time: 30
    Remaining Time: 18, Retries: 0
    Invalid ANN PST recvd: 0
    New GM Temporary Blocking Enforced?: No
    Per-user timer remaining time: 0
    Antireplay Sequence Number: 5
  Peer Sessions:
  Session 1:
    Server handle: 2147483651
    Peer Address: 192.168.1.254
    Peer Version: 1.0.18
    Peer Priority: 100
    Peer KS Role: Primary , Peer KS Status: Alive
    Antireplay Sequence Number: 6

  IKE status: Established
  Counters:
    Ann msgs sent: 2
    Ann msgs sent with reply request: 2
    Ann msgs rcv: 6
    Ann msgs rcv with reply request: 1
    Packet sent drops: 1
    Packet Recv drops: 0
    Total bytes sent: 1350
    Total bytes rcv: 4373
R5#

```

Figure 22: show crypto gdoi ks coop on R5. Secondary role confirmed, R1 visible as Primary peer.

The announcement message counters visible in both outputs are complementary — R1 shows 6 sent and 2 received, while R5 shows 2 sent and 6 received — confirming bidirectional synchronisation is working correctly.

Figure 23 shows show crypto gdoi on R4 during normal COOP operation. R4 is fully registered with R1 (Registered with: 192.168.1.254, Active TEK Number: 1) and its Group Server list includes both KS addresses — 192.168.1.254 and 192.168.1.252 — confirming that the GM is aware of the Secondary KS and will attempt to contact it if the Primary becomes unavailable.

```

R4#show crypto gdoi
GROUP INFORMATION

  Group Name           : myGDOIGroup
  Group Identity       : 123
  Group Type           : GDOI (ISAKMP)
  Crypto Path          : ipv4
  Key Management Path  : ipv4
  Rekeys received      : 1
  IPSec SA Direction   : Both

  Group Server list    : 192.168.1.254
                      : 192.168.1.252

Group Member Information For Group myGDOIGroup:
  IPSec SA Direction   : Both
  ACL Received From KS : gdoi_group_myGDOIGroup_temp_acl

  Group member         : 192.168.1.4      vrf: None
  Local addr/port      : 192.168.1.4/848
  Remote addr/port     : 192.168.1.254/848
  fvrf/ivrf           : None/None
  Version              : 1.0.17
  Registration status  : Registered
  Registered with      : 192.168.1.254
  Re-registers in      : 2216 sec
  Succeeded registration: 2
  Attempted registration: 10
  Last rekey from      : 192.168.1.254
  Last rekey seq num   : 1
  Multicast rekey rcvd : 0
  DP Error Monitoring  : OFF
  IPSEC init reg executed : 0
  IPSEC init reg postponed : 0
  Active TEK Number    : 2
  SA Track (OID/status) : disabled

  allowable rekey cipher: any
  allowable rekey hash  : any
  allowable transformtag: any ESP

  Rekeys cumulative
  Total received        : 1
  After latest register : 0
  Rekey Received        : never

ACL Downloaded From KS 192.168.1.254:
  access-list permit icmp any any

TEK POLICY for the current KS-Policy ACES Downloaded:
GigabitEthernet0/0:
  IPsec SA:
    spi: 0x73E328C0(1944266944)
    KGS: Disabled
    transform: esp-aes esp-sha-hmac
    sa timing:remaining key lifetime (sec): (2374)
    Anti-Replay(Counter Based) : 64
    tag method : disabled
    alg key size: 16 (bytes)
    sig key size: 20 (bytes)
    encaps: ENCAPS_TUNNEL

  IPsec SA:
    spi: 0xCD59C10D(3445211405)
    KGS: Disabled
    transform: esp-aes esp-sha-hmac
    sa timing:remaining key lifetime (sec): (458)
    Anti-Replay(Counter Based) : 64
    tag method : disabled
    alg key size: 16 (bytes)
    sig key size: 20 (bytes)
    encaps: ENCAPS_TUNNEL

R4#

```

Figure 23: show crypto gdoi on R4 under normal COOP operation. Registered with R1 as Primary, both KS addresses present in the server list, TEK active.

6.1.4 Failover Test and RSA Key Issue

To test failover, R1's `gi0/0` interface was shut down while a Wireshark probe captured traffic on the R5-switch link. Figure 24 shows the capture. The early packets (numbered 6 through 83) are the periodic COOP heartbeat announcements from R1 (192.168.1.254) to R5 (192.168.1.252), labelled as *Informational* by Wireshark. After packet 83 the heartbeats from R1 cease, corresponding to the moment the interface was shut down. R5 then sends reply-request announcements attempting to reach R1 (packets 132–224), and upon receiving no response promotes itself to Primary and immediately sends *New Group Mode* rekey messages (exchange type 33) to all three GMs (packets 225–246), pushing itself as the new active KS.

No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Length	Info
6	4.659910	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.252	ISAKMP	742	Informational
21	24.665503	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.252	ISAKMP	742	Informational
36	44.662522	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.252	ISAKMP	742	Informational
52	64.659697	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.252	ISAKMP	742	Informational
66	84.656582	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.252	ISAKMP	742	Informational
83	104.653342	192.168.1.254	192.168.1.252	ISAKMP	742	Informational
102	134.650253	192.168.1.252	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	726	Informational
132	164.647451	192.168.1.252	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	726	Informational
149	194.643523	192.168.1.252	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	742	Informational
164	214.639918	192.168.1.252	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	742	Informational
175	234.637555	192.168.1.252	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	742	Informational
187	254.634837	192.168.1.252	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	742	Informational
202	274.632769	192.168.1.252	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	742	Informational
213	294.631839	192.168.1.252	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	742	Informational
224	309.629842	192.168.1.252	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	950	Informational
225	310.631452	192.168.1.252	192.168.1.2	ISAKMP	766	New Group Mode
226	310.634287	192.168.1.252	192.168.1.3	ISAKMP	766	New Group Mode
227	310.637185	192.168.1.252	192.168.1.4	ISAKMP	766	New Group Mode
234	320.643162	192.168.1.252	192.168.1.2	ISAKMP	766	New Group Mode
235	320.646281	192.168.1.252	192.168.1.3	ISAKMP	766	New Group Mode
236	320.649782	192.168.1.252	192.168.1.4	ISAKMP	766	New Group Mode
243	329.631680	192.168.1.252	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	950	Informational
244	330.651052	192.168.1.252	192.168.1.2	ISAKMP	766	New Group Mode
245	330.653902	192.168.1.252	192.168.1.3	ISAKMP	766	New Group Mode
246	330.656755	192.168.1.252	192.168.1.4	ISAKMP	766	New Group Mode
257	349.632520	192.168.1.252	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	950	Informational
271	369.632670	192.168.1.252	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	950	Informational
283	389.640477	192.168.1.252	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	950	Informational
296	409.649443	192.168.1.252	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	854	Informational
310	429.657313	192.168.1.252	192.168.1.254	ISAKMP	854	Informational

▶ Frame 6: 742 bytes on wire (5936 bits), 742 bytes captured (5936 bits) on interface -, id 0
 ▶ Ethernet II, Src: 0c:1b:5c:4a:00:00 (0c:1b:5c:4a:00:00), Dst: 0c:24:12:7e:00:00 (0c:24:12:7e:00:00)
 ▶ Internet Protocol Version 4, Src: 192.168.1.254, Dst: 192.168.1.252
 ▶ User Datagram Protocol, Src Port: 848, Dst Port: 848
 ▶ Internet Security Association and Key Management Protocol

Figure 24: Wireshark capture on the R5-switch link. COOP heartbeats from R1 stop after packet 83; R5 then sends New Group Mode rekeys to all GMs.

The R5 console messages at the moment of transition are shown in Figure 25. The first message confirms R1 became unreachable; the second confirms R5 transitioned to Primary.

```

R5#
*Jun  4 16:05:42.710: %GDOI-3-COOP_KS_UNREACH: Cooperative KS 192.168.1.254 Unreachable in group myGDOIGroup. IKE SA Status = Failed to establish.
R5#
*Jun  4 16:05:42.710: %GDOI-5-COOP_KS_TRANS_TO_PRI: KS 192.168.1.252 in group myGDOIGroup transitioned to Primary (Previous Primary = 192.168.1.254)

```

Figure 25: R5 console output at the moment of failover. R5 detects R1 as unreachable and promotes itself to Primary.

Figure 26 shows the COOP status on R5 immediately after the transition, confirming Local KS Role: Primary and Peer KS Status: Dead.

```

R5#show crypto gdoi ks coop
Crypto Gdoi Group Name :myGDOIGroup
  Group handle: 2147483650, Local Key Server handle: 2147483650

  Local Address: 192.168.1.252
  Local Priority: 75
  Local KS Role: Primary , Local KS Status: Alive
  Local KS version: 1.0.18
  Primary Timers:
    Primary Refresh Policy Time: 20
    Remaining Time: 6
    Per-user timer remaining time: 0
    Antireplay Sequence Number: 9
  Peer Sessions:
  Session 1:
    Server handle: 2147483651
    Peer Address: 192.168.1.254
    Peer Version: 1.0.18
    Peer Priority: Unknown
    Peer KS Role: Primary , Peer KS Status: Dead
    Antireplay Sequence Number: 62

  IKE status: Established
  Counters:
    Ann msgs sent: 2
    Ann msgs sent with reply request: 5
    Ann msgs rcv: 62
    Ann msgs rcv with reply request: 1
    Packet sent drops: 1
    Packet Recv drops: 0
    Total bytes sent: 3215
    Total bytes rcv: 39980

```

Figure 26: show crypto gdoi ks coop on R5 after R1 failure. R5 has assumed the Primary role.

Despite the clean KS-level transition, the Group Members failed to complete re-registration with R5. Figure 27 shows R4's state during this period: **Registration status: Registering**, **Attempted registration: 9**, and critically **Active TEK Number: 0**, meaning R4 had lost its TEK and was unable to obtain a new one from R5. The same state was observed on R2 and R3. The GM console logs showed repeated alternating registration attempts between 192.168.1.254 and 192.168.1.252, neither succeeding.

```

R4#show crypto gdoi
GROUP INFORMATION

  Group Name           : myGDOIGroup
  Group Identity       : 123
  Group Type           : GDOI (ISAKMP)
  Crypto Path          : ipv4
  Key Management Path  : ipv4
  Rekeys received      : 1
  IPSec SA Direction   : Both

  Group Server list    : 192.168.1.254
                      : 192.168.1.252

Group Member Information For Group myGDOIGroup:
  IPSec SA Direction   : Both
  ACL Received From KS : gdoi_group_myGDOIGroup_temp_acl

  Group member         : 192.168.1.4      vrf: None
    Local addr/port    : 192.168.1.4/848
    Remote addr/port   : 192.168.1.252/848
    fvrf/ivrf         : None/None
    Version            : 1.0.17
    Registration status : Registering
    Registering to     : 192.168.1.252
    Re-registers in    : 67 sec
    Succeeded registration: 1
    Attempted registration: 9
    Last rekey from    : 192.168.1.254
    Last rekey seq num : 1
    Multicast rekey rcvd : 0
    DP Error Monitoring : OFF
    IPSEC init reg executed : 0
    IPSEC init reg postponed : 0
    Active TEK Number   : 0
    SA Track (OID/status) : disabled

    allowable rekey cipher: any
    allowable rekey hash  : any
    allowable transformtag: any ESP

  Rekeys cumulative
    Total received      : 1
    After latest register : 1
    Rekey Received      : never

  ACL Downloaded From KS 192.168.1.254:
    access-list permit icmp any any

TEK POLICY for the current KS-Policy ACEs Downloaded:
R4#conf t

```

Figure 27: show crypto gdoi on R4 during failed re-registration. Active TEK is 0 and registration attempts to R5 are failing. Also comparing with Figure 23 there is nothing under TEK policy.

```

R5#show crypto gdoi ks members

Group Member Information :

Number of rekeys sent for group myGDOIGroup : 0
Number of retransmits during the last rekey for group myGDOIGroup : 0
Duration of the last rekey for group myGDOIGroup : 0 msec

Group Member ID   : 192.168.1.2           GM Version: 1.0.17
Group ID          : 123
Group Name        : myGDOIGroup
Group Type        : GDOI (ISAKMP)
GM State          : Registered
Key Server ID     : 192.168.1.254
Rekeys sent       : 0
Rekeys retries    : 0
Rekey Acks Rcvd   : 0
Rekey Acks missed : 0

Sent seq num : 0      0      0      0
Rcvd seq num : 0      0      0      0

Group Member ID   : 192.168.1.3           GM Version: 1.0.17

Group Member Information :

Group ID          : 123
Group Name        : myGDOIGroup
Group Type        : GDOI (ISAKMP)
GM State          : Registered
Key Server ID     : 192.168.1.254
Rekeys sent       : 0
Rekeys retries    : 0
Rekey Acks Rcvd   : 0
Rekey Acks missed : 0

Sent seq num : 0      0      0      0
Rcvd seq num : 0      0      0      0

Group Member ID   : 192.168.1.4           GM Version: 1.0.17
Group ID          : 123
Group Name        : myGDOIGroup
Group Type        : GDOI (ISAKMP)
GM State          : Registered
Key Server ID     : 192.168.1.254
Rekeys sent       : 0
Rekeys retries    : 0
Rekey Acks Rcvd   : 0
Rekey Acks missed : 0

Group Member Information :

Sent seq num : 0      0      0      0
Rcvd seq num : 0      0      0      0

R5#

```

Figure 28: show crypto gdoi ks members on R5. GMs appear registered from the state synchronised with R1, but Key Server ID still shows 192.168.1.254, indicating no fresh registration with R5 has completed.

Root Cause The failure was caused by an RSA key mismatch between the two Key Servers. During the original GROUPKEY-PULL with R1, each GM received R1's RSA public key and stored it as the trusted key for verifying rekey message signatures. When R5 promoted itself to Primary and sent New Group Mode rekey messages, it signed them with its own independently generated RSA key pair. The GMs attempted to verify these signatures using R1's public key,

which naturally failed, causing every rekey and re-registration attempt with R5 to be rejected.

This is a known and documented limitation of GETVPN COOP when RSA key pairs are generated independently on each KS. Cisco's recommended solution is to deploy a **Public Key Infrastructure (PKI)** with a Certificate Authority (CA): both KSs enroll with the CA and receive signed certificates, and GMs trust any rekey message signed by a certificate issued by that CA rather than trusting a specific KS's public key. This means a GM will accept rekeys from either KS transparently, which is precisely the behaviour required for seamless failover. Conveniently, certificate-based authentication is also one of the extensions suggested in the lab guide as a replacement for the pre-shared key authentication used in the base configuration. The following section describes the PKI setup and the corrected COOP failover.

7 Conclusion